SAT FRESHMAN ▪ READING & WRITING

Transitions Practice Set

Ten official-style transition questions. Choose the word or phrase that best links the ideas — a full answer key is at the end.

10 Questions | Skill: Transitions | Answers at the end

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1 Transitions

1 / 10

Scientists were able to isolate a relatively pure sample of selenium in 1817, the same year they first discovered the element's existence. _____ the isolation process took longer for molybdenum, which was isolated in its pure form three years after scientists first discovered it.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) By contrast,

B) Thus,

C) Similarly,

D) For instance,

2 Transitions

2 / 10

In 1815, while in exile in Jamaica, Venezuelan revolutionary Simón Bolívar penned a letter praising England's republican government and expressing hope that Latin American nations seeking independence from Spain might achieve something similar. The letter was addressed to a local merchant, Henry Cullen; _____ though, Bolívar's goal was to persuade political leaders from England and Europe to support his cause.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) additionally,

B) ultimately,

C) accordingly,

D) consequently,

3 Transitions

3 / 10

A research team led by Gal Badihi has discovered that chimpanzees communicate through exchanges of gestures occurring at a pace similar to that of human conversations. _____ chimpanzee gesture exchanges have short pauses of about 120 milliseconds between communications, comparable to the 200-millisecond average pause between turns in human speech.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) As a result,

B) Specifically,

C) By contrast,

D) Nevertheless,

4 Transitions

4 / 10

For years, biologists have experimented with using grime-eating bacteria rather than harsh chemicals to clean artworks, and results have been impressive overall. _____ these bacterial strains—which can metabolize centuries' worth of oil, glue, dirt, and other surface impurities without creating harmful byproducts—have proven more effective than traditional chemical cleaning methods.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) However,

B) In many cases,

C) As a result,

D) Additionally,

5 Transitions

5 / 10

It has long been thought that humans first crossed a land bridge into the Americas approximately 13,000 years ago. _____ based on radiocarbon dating of samples uncovered in Mexico, a research team recently suggested that humans may have arrived more than 30,000 years ago—much earlier than previously thought.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) As a result,

B) Similarly,

C) However,

D) In conclusion,

6 Transitions

6 / 10

Brain imaging research led by neuroscientist Dwaynica Greaves found that actors showed suppressed responses in the left anterior prefrontal cortex (the portion of the brain associated with self-awareness) when their names were called during performances; _____ the actors' responses were normal in nonacting contexts. These findings suggest that when embodying characters, performers may temporarily set aside their personal identities.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A) specifically,

B) conversely,

C) likewise,

D) thus,

7 Transitions

7 / 10

In 1845, the United States District Court for the state of Iowa was established. Initially, the court's jurisdiction was a single district that encompassed the entire state, but as Iowa's population grew, this single district began to struggle to serve the needs of everyone in the state. _____ the court's jurisdiction was subdivided into two districts, each with its own district court.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A Nevertheless,

B Ultimately,

C Additionally,

D For example,

8 Transitions

8 / 10

Researchers believe that pieces of hull found off Oregon's coast are from a Spanish cargo ship that was lost in 1697. Stories passed down among the area's Confederated Tribes of Siletz Indians support this belief. _____ Siletz stories describe how blocks of beeswax, an item the ship had been carrying, began washing ashore after the ship was lost.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A For this reason,

B For example,

C However,

D Likewise,

9 Transitions

9 / 10

Alexander Lawrence Posey (1873–1908) varied his focus and tone depending on the genre in which he was writing. In his poetry, he used heartfelt language to evoke the beauty and peacefulness of his natural surroundings; in his journalism, _____ he employed humor and satire to comment on political issues affecting his Muskogee Creek community.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A that is,

B granted,

C similarly,

D by contrast,

10 Transitions

10 / 10

Okot p'Bitek's poem *Song of Lawino* (1966) explores postcolonial Ugandan life through the eyes of a woman living in a rural village. With its vibrant imagery, bitingly satiric tone, and dexterous use of traditional Acholi song and phraseology, the poem inspired a generation of East African writers. _____ those who adopted its style are often referred to as Okot School poets.

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A Nevertheless,

B Fittingly,

C By comparison,

D Instead,

ANSWER KEY

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
A	B	B	B	C	B	B	B	D	B

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